

BEHAVIOURAL ACTIVATION

My simple guide for the next couple of weeks

DO FIRST. MOTIVATION CAN FOLLOW.

1. WHAT IT MEANS

- Low mood can lead to doing less of the right things.
- Doing less means fewer chances for pleasure, achievement and connection.
- Behavioural Activation means taking small useful actions even when I do not feel like it.

2. MY FIVE RULES

- Do not wait until I feel ready.
- Choose small actions linked to my values.
- Plan when and where I will do them.
- Notice avoidance, then do the smallest useful step.
- Good enough beats waiting for perfect.

3. WHAT I AM LOOKING FOR

P = Pleasure

Something enjoyable or calming.

A = Achievement

Something completed or moved forward.

C = Connection

Something that helps me feel closer to people.

4. MY CURRENT EXAMPLES

- Reading each day: pleasure, focus and routine.
- Allotment and plants: pleasure and achievement.
- Work-app ban: peace, sleep and boundaries.
- Admin and household jobs: achievement.
- Cards, calls and time with people: connection.

MY QUICK DAILY CHECK-IN

1. What is one small personal action and one work action today?
2. Did avoidance show up? What excuse or delay did I notice?
3. What was the smallest useful action I took?
4. What did it give me: P, A or C?

Optional: mood before ___/10 mood after ___/10

No need to complete every workbook page. Keep using the Personal and Work goal grids, stay small, and keep moving.

Based on Kirsty's Behavioural Activation pack from Psychology Tools.